



Association of Zoos & Aquariums

2020 AZA CONSERVATION GRANTS FUND

Application Instructions

DEADLINE

This 2020 Conservation Grants Fund (CGF) electronic application must be used for all proposals. Completed applications must be submitted via email no later than **5:00 p.m. EDT** on **16 March 2020**. An auto-response email with a time-stamp will confirm receipt of the application.

*Incomplete applications, or applications received after 5:00 p.m. EDT on 16 March 2020, **regardless of cause**, will NOT be eligible for consideration. NO DEADLINE EXCEPTIONS WILL BE MADE.*

MEMBERSHIP

The Principal Investigator (PI) and all Co-Investigators (CIs) *must be individual AZA members* at the Professional Associate, Professional Affiliate, Professional Fellow, or Student level. Institutional membership does not count as individual membership and individual members at the Friend level are not eligible. Other participants actively involved in the completion of the project should be listed as collaborators and are not required to be AZA members. To apply for membership, visit <https://www.aza.org/individual-membership>.

FUNDING TIMELINE

All CGF projects must be completed within 12 months. CGF grants are intended to serve as seed money to attract additional funding and proposals should request funds only for this one-year period. Identical components of a project will not be funded for more than two grant cycles; however, funding requests for different components of the same project may be applied for in subsequent grant cycles.

CGF proposals undergo a two-tiered review process, outlined at <https://www.aza.org/cgf-selection-process>. Applicants will be notified of funding decisions in early September 2020 and funds will be available 1 October 2020. CGF funds can only be used for proposal expenses incurred on or after the award date. Expenses incurred prior to the award date will not be covered by CGF funds.

APPLICATION GUIDELINES

The CGF application and all supplemental forms are posted online at: <http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/>. These documents contain form fields that must be completed and submitted via email to: CGFapp@aza.org. *All application materials must be in electronic format. No hard copies of any application materials will be accepted.*

It is strongly recommended that you save a copy of your completed application and supplemental forms as a backup. *Only* completed applications, submitted by the deadline defined above, will be reviewed. Applicants will be informed electronically if their application is incomplete.

APPLICATION INSTRUCTIONS AND CHECKLIST: All completed application materials must be submitted **in one email** by the deadline identified above and include the following:

CGF Application: The application is one document consisting of the three sections outlined below. All sections must be complete in order for the application to be considered complete. The application must be submitted as a Microsoft Word document titled “**Application**” and attached to your CGF Application email.

Applications submitted in Portable Document Format (PDF) will NOT be eligible for consideration. NO EXCEPTIONS WILL BE MADE.

Note that “spell checker” and “track changes” functions cannot be used in this form. AZA strongly recommends that applicants compose the content for their Project Abstract and Project Proposal in a separate document to make use of these features, and then copy and paste the final text into the form fields. When composing in a separate document, be aware of character limitations. If the copied text exceeds the character limit when pasted into a form field, *all text exceeding the character limitation will be cut off and will not appear in the final proposal.*

Also note that certain formatting such as italics, bold, and underlining, is unavailable due to the application format. AZA recommends the use of numbering and spacing to emphasize important points in the text.

- ☒ **Cover Sheet.** Fill in the text fields for the project title, amount requested, and PI and CI information. Choose *two* project categories from the given list. Include a project abstract no longer than 1,500 characters, including spaces.
- ☒ **Project Proposal.** Text fields are provided for responses to questions 1-12. Fields have a limit on the number of characters that may be used to keep the application concise. Character limits, including spaces, are stated following each question. If a question is not applicable to your proposal, write “N/A” in the field but *do not leave any form fields blank*, as this may delay processing of your application.
- ☒ **Budget.** Required budgetary information includes:
 - ☒ Detailed Project Budget. Detail how the budget will be allocated to specific items and indicate which funding source will pay for each item. State the total project budget, the amount requested from CGF, and other financial support applied for or received. Each of these amounts should reflect the one-year duration of the project. Funding decisions are announced in early September and CGF funds are to be used for work from the announcement date forward. Expenses incurred prior to the announcement will not be covered by CGF funds.
 - ☒ Budget Justification. Provide an explanation of why specific major items are essential to the project and reasonable in cost.

Required Attachments: The following must be attached to your CGF Application email:

- ☒ **Curricula Vitae.** A curriculum vitae (CV) is required for **each** PI and CI listed on the Cover Sheet and must follow the format stated in these guidelines. CVs must not exceed a **maximum** length of two letter-sized (8.5 by 11 inch) pages each and must be typed in a legible font size (12 point recommended); each side of the paper counts as one page. CVs may be attached for collaborators but are not required. Each CV must be submitted as a separate document entitled, “**CV Investigator’s Last Name.**” *CVs that exceed the maximum length will be cut off at the second page.*
- ☒ **Statement of Institutional Support Forms.** Electronically signed *Statements of Institutional Support* from the CEO(s)/Institutional Director(s) (not the COO, General Curator, Vice President, Dean, or Department Director) of the PI’s institution and **EACH** CI institution *and* collaborating institution must be attached to the CGF Application email as separate documents titled “**SIS**

Institution's Name. The *Statement of Institutional Support* form can be found with the rest of the CGF Application materials on the AZA website identified above.

Applicants wishing to include support letters from entities *other than* PI and CI institutions, collaborating institutions, or AZA Animal Programs may submit such items as appendices.

Note that letters of support from PI and CI institutions and collaborating institutions will not be accepted in lieu of the *Statement of Institutional Support* form. In addition, letters of support/endorsement **from AZA Animal (Taxon Advisory Groups, Species Survival Plans®, etc.) and SAFE Programs** are not accepted although coordination with AZA Animal and SAFE Programs is encouraged and should be described in Question 1. To assure Animal and SAFE Program review of all relevant CGF submissions, AZA Program Leaders will serve as expert reviewers in the CGF application review process and may express their support for a proposal at that time.

- ☐ **Permits.** If permits are required to complete your proposed project, you must attach a copy of each to your CGF Application email. Each permit attached to the CGF Application email must be titled **"Permit #."** *If you are not able to obtain a required permit before submitting this proposal, you must submit it by 15 June 2020 to ensure award eligibility.*
- ☐ **Proposal Resubmission Form.** If a proposal for this project was previously submitted for CGF funding and rejected, the revised proposal *must* include a completed *Proposal Resubmission Form* as an attachment on the CGF Application email. This attachment must be submitted as a Microsoft Word document titled **"Resubmission Form"** and attached to your CGF Application email. *Resubmission forms submitted in Portable Document Format (PDF) will not be accepted.* The form can be found with the rest of the CGF Application materials on the AZA website identified above.

Note: Proposals that fail to provide all items identified in the above checklist in the correct format will not be reviewed.

Non-Required Attachments: The following attachments to your CGF Application email are optional:

- ☒ **Citations (recommended).** Citations/references for statements made in the Project Proposal should be included in a separate document titled **"Citations"** and attached to the CGF Application email.
- ☐ **Appendices.** Appendices are allowed, but may only *clarify*, and not *supplement*, information in the narrative. For example, photos or diagrams would be acceptable, but not videos or publications. Appendices must be attached to the CGF Application email titled **"Appendix #."**

Note: Appendices that do not adhere to these guidelines will be removed from the proposal prior to review.

SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

By submitting your application, you agree, if funded, to abide by the Grant Terms and Conditions posted on AZA's website at <http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/>.

Proposals must be submitted electronically using the 2020 CGF Application and related forms via a **single email, with the proposal title as the subject line**, to CGFapp@aza.org no later than 5:00 p.m. EDT on 16 March 2020. Hard copies of any application materials or applications received after this deadline will not be accepted *regardless of cause*.

AZA's email system accepts messages up to 8 MB in size. In cases when applications are too large to be accepted in one email, AZA will accept the application submission in two separate emails, provided that the same proposal title is identified in the subject line of each.

The 2020 CGF Application email **must** include the following attachments

- CGF Application (this completed form);
- CVs for each Principal and Co- Investigator(s);
- Statements of Institutional Support for each PI and CI institution and collaborating institution; and
- A Proposal Resubmission form, if applicable.
- The Application email may also include citation and appendices attachments.

Auto-response emails will be sent to applicants confirming receipt of the application package. If an auto-response is not received, please resubmit the application. If an applicant submits more than one proposal, s/he should ensure that an auto-response was received for *each* submission. If submission problems arise, contact the AZA office at 301-562-0777. If you submit your application after the 5:00 p.m. deadline, you may still receive an auto-response from the CGF Application inbox; however, your proposal will not be reviewed.

Applications which fail to follow submission instructions or are time-stamped after the deadline will not be considered and applicants will be notified that their application is inadmissible.

APPLICATION ASSISTANCE

The CGF website (<http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/>) contains a wealth of information to help applicants compose a competitive proposal.

Proposals received before 7 March will be reviewed by AZA staff to ensure that the application is completed correctly. Early submission allows time for AZA staff to inform applicants if problems are noted in time for resubmission. Please note that AZA staff does not review early proposals for content.

2020 AZA CONSERVATION GRANTS FUND Cover Sheet

Project Number: 20-1680
For AZA use only

Title of Project: Integrated Community Conservation Action in Uganda

Amount Requested: \$18,000 (round to the nearest whole dollar)

Project Start Date: October 2020

End Date: September 2021 [Project has been ongoing since 2006; activities described in the grant will be completed in this time period]
(CGF funding is for one year only, beginning no earlier than the award date)

Principal Investigators: Each Principal Investigator (PI) and Co-Investigators (CI) *must be an individual AZA member at the time of application* at the Professional Associate, Professional Affiliate, Professional Fellow, or Student level. Institutional membership does not count as individual membership. Other participants should be listed as collaborators on this form.

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) is required for each PI and CI, and a Statement of Institutional Support (SIS) form is required for each PI and CI Organization.

1. Principal Investigator (PI) Name and Title: Michael Stern, Curator of Primates & Small Mammals;
Co-Founder & Project Director

CV Attached? ☒ (required – no more than 2 pages)

Checking this box indicates agreement to the CGF Terms and Conditions (required; available at:
<http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/> ☒ (required)

Individual AZA Member Number: yes (required)

Institution/Organization: Philadelphia Zoo / New Nature Foundation

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☒ (required)

Institutional Address: 3400 W. Girard Avenue, Philadelphia, PA, 19104

Phone: 215-243-5352

E-mail: stern.michael@phillyzoo.org

2. Co-Investigator (CI) Name and Title:

CV Attached? ☐ (required – no more than 2 pages)

Checking this box indicates agreement to the CGF Terms and Conditions (available at:
<http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/> ☐ (required)

Individual AZA Member Number: (required)

Institution/Organization:

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☐ (required)

Institutional Address:

Phone:

E-mail:

3. Co-Investigator (CI) Name and Title:

CV Attached? ☐ (required – no more than 2 pages)

Checking this box indicates agreement to the CGF Terms and Conditions (available at:
<http://www.aza.org/cgf-information-for-applicants/> ☐ (required)

Individual AZA Member Number: (required)

Institution/Organization:

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☐ (required)

Institutional Address:

Phone:

E-mail:

Note: If additional Co-Investigators need to be included, add their information in a separate document titled “**Additional Co-Investigators**” and include it as an attachment to your CGF Application email.

Collaborating Institutions or Organizations: A collaborating institution is defined as any institution actively involved in the design or completion of the project. Funding institutions *not* actively involved in project design or completion should be listed in the “Grant/Matching Support” section of the Project Budget and need not be listed as collaborators.

List all collaborating institutions below, including the PI’s and CI’s institutions listed on the Cover Sheet, as well as those associated with the personnel listed in Question 6, and attach a Statement of Institutional Support form for each collaborating institution to the CGF Application email.

Collaborating Institution Names:

Philadelphia Zoo *Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached?* ☒ (required)

New Nature Foundation *Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached?* ☒ (required)

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☐ (required)

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☐ (required)

Statement of Institutional Support Form Attached? ☐ (required)

Note: If additional Collaborating Institutions or Organizations need to be included, add their information in a separate document titled “**Additional Collaborators**” and include it as an attachment to your CGF Application email.

Project Categories (choose two that best describe the project):

☐ Animal/Population Management (*Ex situ*)

☐ Research

☒ Conservation Education

☐ Animal Health

☒ Field Conservation (*In situ*)

☐ Animal Welfare

Project Abstract (limit 1,500 characters with spaces):

Uganda is an extraordinarily biologically diverse country, and this richness is currently threatened by untenable human practices. With the nation’s rapidly growing human population, the daily fuel wood needs that were once sustainable have reached a threshold. According to Uganda’s National Forest Authority, 63% of forest cover has already been lost, primarily due to tree-cutting for firewood, timber and charcoal, as well as the growth of farms and towns. As a result, there is a need to proactively plan for the future of the wildlife, wild places and the Ugandan citizens who share this land. New Nature Foundation is acting to conserve vulnerable landscapes and species by working in concert with people living along their borders. By respecting the needs of the human populations, NNF believes wildlife populations will receive a similar reverence. Together, we are achieving three primary objectives: 1) Facilitating cost effective fuel efficiency and eco-friendly fuel sources; 2) Providing innovative and integrated environmental education, and; 3) Empowering individuals to take charge of conserving their country’s flora and fauna while improving their own daily lives.

Project Proposal

1. Describe the overall project and its significance for conservation and/or management. What species, sites, habitats, populations, or questions are targeted or addressed and what critical needs will be met? Explain the project's relevance for AZA animal/conservation/education programs or institutions, and/or how it reflects the priorities of the AZA Board (e.g., sustainability of managed populations, SAFE: Savings Animals From Extinction) or of related Animal or SAFE species programs. **LIMIT 5,000 CHARACTERS with spaces**

The overall project is a multi-faceted, targeted approach to assuage the fuel-wood crisis that is threatening Uganda's Kibale National Park (KNP) and all of its species. KNP sustains the last significant tract of pre-montane forest in East Africa, and it is listed as one of the last refuges for a variety of plants and animals (Chapman 2013). The habitat is becoming increasingly biologically isolated, endangering this remarkable assortment of wildlife which includes: the last viable population of Ugandan Red Colobus (Endangered); the largest contiguous population of Eastern Chimpanzees (Endangered); ten other species of primates; Elephants (Vulnerable), three species of pigs; five species of antelopes; 29 species of amphibians; 50 species of reptiles; 350 species of birds; 200+ species of butterflies and countless others – all of which benefit from the habitat protection achieved by this work.

Immediately bordering KNP the population depends on wood for household energy needs. The forest fragments that once sustained people and wildlife populations are rapidly disappearing due to intensive fuel wood usage. The few primate populations that do survive in these fragments are found to be “unhealthy and psychologically stressed” (Chapman 2013). Further exacerbating the issue is the increased demand for charcoal, which is often made from hardwood trees within KNP. All of this points to the importance of better protecting KNP with a long-term strategy.

Both the Chimpanzee SAFE program and the Ape TAG Conservation Initiative list deforestation as one of the major threats facing chimps. Many other species commonly kept under human care at AZA facilities can also be found in Kibale and are benefitting from this project, including the following for which there are active SSPs: Abdim's Stork, African Buffalo, African Elephant, African Spoonbill, Amethyst Starling, Banded Mongoose, Black Crake, Blue Duiker, Crested Guinea fowl, Crested Porcupine, European White Stork, Great Blue Turaco, Great White Pelican, Grey Crowned Crane, Guereza Colobus, Hadada Ibis, Hammerkop, Hooded Vulture, Lady Ross's Turaco, Lesser Flamingo, Marabou Stork, Ruppell's Griffon Vulture, Sacred Ibis, Saddle-billed Stork, Schmidt's Red-tailed Monkey, Secretary Bird, Serval, Sitatunga, Snowy-headed Robin Chat, Warthog, Waterbuck, White-backed Vulture & Yellow-billed Stork. Other species commonly kept at AZA institutions outside of SSP programs that can be found in Kibale include Agamas, Barn Owl, Bataleur, Chameleons, Forest Cobra, Gaboon Viper, Francolins, Geckos & Rhinoceros Viper. The links between Kibale and AZA collections cannot be overstated.

Addressing the protection of wildlife habitat is our primary goal, achieved through tree planting, efficient stoves, biomass briquettes and a many-pronged education campaign. It is also important to improve the relationships and attitudes the people who live along the borders have toward KNP. A study in 2017 found “decreasing perceived benefits and increasing perceived problems associated with the protected area [KNP] over time”; It went on emphasize that understanding people's perceptions will be key to engaging communities and making adaptations to benefit the park (Mackenzie 2017). NNF works to understand the current opinions towards KNP and recognizes that perceptions change over time, which is why the program is dedicated to its long-term strategy. By consistently engaging communities and evaluating and improving the methods, positive attitudes towards KNP and conservation behaviors are more likely to occur.

2. List the goal(s) and associated objective(s) of the proposed project and the actions that will be taken to achieve them. Goals should describe the desired status in the long-term of the question or problem that project will address. Objectives should state the immediate results that are necessary to meet the long-term goal(s). Actions should be the specific activities the project will undertake to complete each objective. If the proposal is a request to fund part of a larger project, this section should focus on the part for which CGF funding is being requested during the one-year duration, while also providing some context regarding the larger effort. **LIMIT 4,500 CHARACTERS with spaces**

1. GOAL: To protect wildlife habitat by reducing the amount of firewood taken illegally from KNP

OBJECTIVES:

- Provide alternatives to encroaching into KNP
- Provide alternatives to the charcoal
- Provide alternatives to the few remaining forest fragments

ACTIONS

- Promoting native legumes to plant as firewood
- Promoting efficient cooking alternatives
- Providing education on the benefits of KNP



2. GOAL: Increased prevalence and use of efficient stoves, home-grown firewood and biomass briquettes to address deforestation of KNP.

OBJECTIVE

- Make training easily available for those interested
- Have alternatives available for barter or sale

ACTION

- Ongoing fuel efficient stove program
- At least 150 stoves built with NNF assistance this year
- At least 300,000 biomass briquettes produced
- 6 workshops on fuel efficiency

3. GOAL: Use successful strategies to effect behavior change in large audiences that results in more active conservation partners.

OBJECTIVE

- Monitoring of numbers produced, sold and bartered
- Continued sales/bartering will evidence use of the materials
- Five community Science Centers will be opened 2-3 days each week

ACTION

- 50,000 interactions at NNF's 5 Science Centers
- Tooro Botanical Gardens trips awarded to people who participate in deforestation curriculum
- KNP trips awarded to people who complete deforestation curriculum
- At least 3,000 people attending annual Competitions
- 6 Workshops on conservation, threats to KNP, and what people can do
- Targeting at least 5,000 other interactions with local citizens, outside of the Science Centers

3. Explain in detail the methodology for this project and why it is appropriate. If this is a research project, clearly state research question(s) and how it will be tested. For applied conservation projects, explain how project actions will be undertaken and proposed actions are appropriate for addressing the conservation issue addressed. If this is a conservation education or professional training project, describe the methods as they relate to the target audience, number of people that will be reached, etc. **LIMIT 7,000**

CHARACTERS with spaces

NNF acts on decades of published research to address deforestation and the fuel wood crisis in ways that protect wildlife habitat while simultaneously addressing the needs of people. We actively involve large audiences, educate and support community members on the building of efficient stoves, promote fast growing non-invasive firewood crops on home farms and produce and instruct about alternatives to charcoal. In 2020, NNF is also introducing a recycling/zero waste program, the first of its kind in the country. Along with those activities, NNF creates opportunities for people to learn about and appreciate their country's wild places and wildlife through five community Science Centers, outdoor video shows, workshops, classes, annual competitions and nature walks. These programs are designed to improve the people-park relationship, damaged by years of crop raiding, lack of compensation, and lack of alternatives for a family's daily needs. Our methodology is based in empowerment of people to meet their own needs. Local citizens are active participants and are required to invest in all of the programs and work hard for their successful outcomes; there are no handouts.

All members of the villages of Kanyawara, Isunga, Kaswa, Nabweya, nearby communities and the town of Fort Portal, young and old, are the targets for the programs listed below. NNF believes informal education, constructivist learning and inquiry methods of teaching are much more impactful than the rote memorization taught in local schools. As such, the project is always experimenting with new ways to attract and excite large audiences about conservation. The opportunities provided by NNF allow students to perform better in school, and the entire community learns and explores nature in a way never afforded to them before. Jobs are provided, cultural dancing and storytelling are embraced and people gain skills

like reading and writing, which leads to countless other benefits. We have personally witnessed the pride and delight of so many individuals, which, while sometimes difficult to transcribe into data, is a clear indicator of the difference these programs are having on the lives of people and animals. Below are descriptions of NNF's various initiatives.

Science Centers: NNF's five community Science Centers were the first institutions of their kind in Uganda. With the ultimate goal of changing the way people feel and act toward the forest, these centers teach biology, anthropology, geography, conservation science, proper land use strategies and what climate change means for the local community, as well as general literacy, art and math. They include animal skeletons, specimens and skins, confiscated poacher's items, science and school curriculum books, cultural artifacts and art materials. The Science Centers highlight NNF's efficient stove design, briquettes and leguminous tree species that can maximize homegrown firewood production.

Nature Connect: NNF is actively helping to create a community of Ugandan people who have experienced, connected with and appreciated the beautiful treasures that exist in their own backyards. Building on the success of 2018's program (funded by WAZA) and because of local demand, the 2020 program will focus on deforestation through curriculum and field trips. This initiative will engage returning and new visitors and offer opportunities in and out of the field to enjoy nature, honor the rare and unique flora and fauna of Uganda, and be more active conservationists.

Stoves: NNF's adaptation of the Winiarski Rocket Stove is built from mud and dung, so it costs little or nothing, yet it lasts for many years and uses 30-60% less wood than traditional stoves.

Briquettes: Utilizing farm and industrial waste like banana peels and sawdust, NNF produces carbonized briquettes (which burn like charcoal) to sell in town and non-carbonized briquettes (which burn like firewood) to barter in the village.

Conservation Competitions: These occur annually in each target area and are attended by the general public and members of local wildlife and women's clubs who present performances. In 2019, the four events enjoyed an audience of more than 2,800 people, exceeding, yet again, our highest attendance since project inception.

Video Shows: Nature films have been proven to significantly increase people's knowledge on any given topic, in some cases more so than what is gained from a traditional classroom setting (Arendt & Matthes, 2015). NNF utilizes solar power to project nature films to large audiences on a weekly rotation (weather permitting) in each of the project's target areas, affording villagers whose only animal encounters had been negative a new way to view wildlife.

Recycling Program: Plastic bottles, bags, scrap metal and papers litter the streets of Fort Portal, clog the rivers and infiltrate the forests and savannas nearby. With a deeply rooted environmental program already in place, NNF will now include this issue as a natural evolution of the current energy efficiency and environmental education campaigns. Waste will be cleaned from natural areas and turned into art, utilitarian items and crafts, and will be marketed to Ugandan citizens and the international community. Working with Ugandan artists in the mediums of plastic bottles, plastic bags and scrap metals, we will create innovative art installations, including at least one 15' tall animal on the main road and a three-dimensional mural at the town Science Center. Additionally, training will be provided on how to reuse trash to create furniture, crafts and buildings. This will all be in association with a campaign to sensitize citizens on how we all can better protect our world. Like everywhere else this is an issue, reduced demand for single-use products will lead to their reduction to a manageable level.

Community Workshops: Workshops focus on efficient stoves & biomass briquettes (targeting adult men and women), recycling, field guide training and career planning (targeting teenagers of both sexes), family planning/women's health (with workshops for teens of both sexes and adult women), and stories from the elders (targeting all ages) to pass on oral traditions.

Staff Training Workshops: Each year, staff visit a national park somewhere in the country, which keeps them engaged, enhances knowledge, and increases their teaching skills. In 2019, they visited Mt. Elgon National Park.

4. If previous CGF funding was obtained for this or a related project, summarize relevant findings and identify how they relate to the current proposal. **LIMIT 1,000 CHARACTERS with spaces**

This project has not received Funding from CGF.

5. Describe the timeline in which components of the project will be completed within the one-year project duration. Use of bulleted/numbered lists is encouraged. **LIMIT 1,500 CHARACTERS with spaces**

All of the project's activities are ongoing throughout the year and culminate with conservation competitions in late December.

By the end of 2020, we expect to have achieved the following goals:

- Match or exceed 2019's Science Center attendance
- Match or exceed 2019's biomass briquette production and sales
- Re-introduce the nature connect program initiated with WAZA in 2018
- Create at least two sculptures or murals made from recycled materials in Fort Portal town
- Increase scope of workshops to include recycling (in addition to fuel efficiency and family planning)

- Meet or exceed 2019's stove building totals
- Expand yearly conservation competitions to include Fort Portal town
- Investigate alternative uses for plastic bottles used by local hotels



6. Define the project team by identifying the personnel included for this project, their roles, qualifications, and the key skills they bring. Discuss the PI and each CI listed on the Cover Sheet and any collaborators (persons actively involved in the completion of the project). Each collaborator's institution should be listed under **Collaborating Institutions or Organizations** on the application Cover Sheet. **LIMIT 2,500 CHARACTERS with spaces**

Michael Stern & Rebecca Goldstone, Founders & Project Directors, have worked in and around Kibale since 2000. They have long-standing relationships with community members and government officials. Now based in the US, Rebecca runs NNF and Michael is the Curator of Primates & Small Mammals at Philadelphia Zoo. They conduct research, develop methodologies, support training of Ugandan staff, interns and volunteers and provide general oversight. They travel to Uganda 2-3 times annually to ensure the program's successful evolution.

Margaret Kemigisa, Project Manager. Since inception in 2006, Margaret has overseen all in-situ activities. She trains and supervises ~30 staff and hosts international experts and volunteers. Key roles include maintaining good working relationships with target audiences & local leaders, engaging the community in educational events, and maintaining enthusiasm and support for NNF's initiatives. Margaret is also the first ever female mayor of Kiko Parish, a position that synergizes well with her leadership role at NNF.

Sam Murungi, Science Center Supervisor, worked with NNF when it opened its first Science Center in 2006. After several years he moved to the capital but found the village calling him back and was re-hired in 2016 to oversee all five Science Centers. He is responsible for staff training, lesson plans, maintaining equipment and the structures housing the Science Centers, monthly reporting and overseeing annual conservation competitions.

Raegan Kandole, Recycled Art Project Lead leads all aspects of NNF's awareness raising campaign about recycling and providing creative and utilitarian outlets for alternative uses of "rubbish."

Richard Muhabwe, Warden, Uganda Wildlife Authority, executes the wood extraction study in KNP.

Collaborating Organizations:

Uganda Wildlife Authority: Conducts bi-annual wood extraction survey (funded by NNF) and supports outreach initiatives.

Community Action Project: This registered Community Based Organization partners on workshops and events and helps promote all project activities.

McLeod Russel Tea: Provides space, electricity and materials for manufacturing biomass briquettes; Purchases briquettes monthly to distribute to its staff.

EcoAction Uganda: Collaborating with NNF on an intensive public art and recycling campaign in and around Fort Portal.

Tooro Botanic Garden: Sells biomass briquettes; Partnered with NNF in the recent past on programs to bring Ugandans into the gardens.

7. Describe the project's monitoring and evaluation plans. Explain how the goals and objectives of the project will be met, which indicators will be used, and how those indicators will be measured. If this project has an educational or professional training component, the educational impact should be discussed (ideally including impacts on conservation-related knowledge, attitudes/affect, and behavior). Plans may be quantitative or qualitative, and should differentiate between monitoring (ensuring proposed actions are taken) and evaluation (whether the project had the desired impact on the issue or question addressed). **LIMIT 3,000 CHARACTERS with spaces**

NNF staff are constantly evaluating and adapting the work in the following ways:

- Calculating wood saved as a result of NNF's programs through 400 annual surveys of random households with data collected on stove and fuel type, amount of wood used and wood sources
- NNF funds research being conducted by a Uganda Wildlife Authority warden on wood extracted illegally from the park, comparing areas where we work with those we don't. Several two-kilometer long transects are studied, enumerating occurrences of illegal wood collection. This is repeated every two years, and adds to a long-term data set detailing human activity along the boundaries of KNP
- Annual records of briquettes sold at the urban Science Center and briquettes traded at the village production facility
- GPS data points for families using efficient stoves and briquettes, demarcating proximity to the protected area, the total number of stoves being used and age of the stoves
- Formal and informal interviews with workshop attendees, eco-char customers, science center regulars and new visitors, and home visits to families using stoves and planting fuel wood trees
- Calculating the number of individuals viewing the recycled art and collecting feedback
- Documenting increased involvement from local stakeholders around Fort Portal town
- Success is also measured by continued or increased attendance at NNF workshops, competitions, science centers and video shows

While continued attendance at Science Centers and events, reduced wood use and increased awareness of local environmental issues is the main evaluation for our educational campaign, a more formal evaluation of the new recycling program is beginning in 2020. NNF will conduct formal and informal surveys prior to and at the completion of this program to evaluate Ugandan citizen's understanding of what waste is, what effect it has on our environment and our health and how they can be more resourceful, use fewer non-compostable materials and better recycle other items. This program will also work directly with local hotels and will measure the actual amount of waste diverted from landfill from these facilities. Requests at the Science Centers for more literature and activities regarding zero waste, recycling, renewable materials and a healthy environment will be another way to measure the success of these programs. Sales and orders of the recycled crafts or requests for more art installations would be an additional measure.

8. Explain and identify the means, and timeline of how the key results and lessons of the project will be disseminated and shared. Key internal and external audiences should be identified. **LIMIT 1,500 CHARACTERS with spaces**

NNF's will publish results in its annual report that will be submitted in early 2021 and available on the website. Directors plan to publish the data collected over the course of the project at some point in the future. We also continue to lecture across the US and Uganda and present at conferences around the world. (The c-founders have presented lectures and posters at AZA conferences several times.) In 2019, NNF presented at the African Primatological Society's annual conference, Columbus Zoo and Aquarium, Denver Zoo, Koholet high school, Oakland Zoo, Philadelphia Zoo, St. Joseph's University and Virginia Zoo.

9. Have all the necessary permits been obtained for the project?

a) ☐ Yes ☐ No ☒ Not Applicable

If yes, list the permits here and attach one copy of each to your CGF Application email. Attachments should be titled "**Permit #.**"

NA

- b) If the necessary permits have not yet been obtained, please explain why. **Pending permits must be obtained and submitted to AZA by 15 June 2020.**

NA

10. If research animals are to be purchased for the project, indicate and justify the destination of the animal(s) after completion of the research. **LIMIT 750 CHARACTERS with spaces**

NA

11. If this is a multi-year project, identify the funding strategy for subsequent years. **LIMIT 750 CHARACTERS with spaces**

The project has been ongoing since 2006, with more than 30 AZA and WAZA partners over the years. With several long-term partners and private funding, we have been able to accomplish all of our goals to date. If full funding is not secured in the future, the main goals of the project would still be accomplished, albeit through a scaled down version of operatinios, if needed.

12. **Past CGF Support.** If any of the proposal's Principal or Co-Investigators listed on the Cover Sheet have received previous CGF support, complete the required information below for each.

- | | | |
|--|----------------|-----------------------------|
| a) Name of Investigator: | Year of Award: | Amount of Award: |
| Project Title: | | |
| Were all required reports (annual/final) submitted? ☐ Yes | | ☐ No |
| b) Name of Investigator: | Year of Award: | Amount of Award: |
| Project Title: | | |
| Were all required reports (annual/final) submitted? ☐ Yes | | ☐ No |

Note: If additional awards need to be included, add their information to a separate document titled **"Past CGF Projects"** and include it as an attachment with your CGF Application email.

2020 AZA CONSERVATION GRANTS FUND

Project Budget

BUDGET CYCLE

All funding requests from CGF must be for a maximum period of one year only. Funding decisions are announced in early September and expenses incurred prior to the award date will not be covered by CGF funds. CGF funds are to be used within one year from the project start date and forward.

DETAILED BUDGET

A detailed budget sheet is provided below and information should be separated into CGF and non-CGF costs. List under each category the budget items and method of calculation for each (e.g., 2 persons x 10 days x \$25/day), as well as probable sources of support. The following should be listed as **separate** budget items:

- airfares
- lodging
- vehicle rental (automobiles, planes, boats)
- fuel
- per diem
- equipment over \$500
- supplies, services (lab analyses, editing)
- pharmaceuticals
- shipping/postage
- printing
- personnel costs

CGF does not fund the following: Tuition, university fees, or fringe benefits associated with graduate students or other project personnel; administrative costs (including institutional overhead and submission costs for the publication of journal articles); travel unrelated to completion of the project (conference presentation expenses, travel to meetings, etc.); planning meetings that define, rather than implement, conservation/management/education goals.

CGF does not fund salaries for project personnel other than graduate students, technicians, and start-up positions established solely for the purpose of completion of the project.

Note: Recipients of CGF grants are obligated to inform AZA (CGF@aza.org) of any pending or overlapping grants received. If such grants are received, AZA's CGF Scientific Advisory Committee may recommend that the CGF award amount be reduced or refunded.

Note: If additional budget items need to be included, add this information in a separate document titled "**Additional Budget Items**" and include it as an attachment with your CGF Application email.

Budget Items Form:

Budget Item	Method of Calculation (e.g., 2 persons x 10 days x \$25/day)	CGF- Requested Amount	Non-CGF Requested Amount (if applicable)	Date Expected from Non-CGF Source (if applicable and not yet received)	Name of Non-CGF Source (e.g., Grant Fund, Matching)	Total Expense (CGF+Non-CGF)
Director	Annually	\$	\$33,750	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$33,750
Ugandan Project Manager	Annually	\$	\$6,500	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$6,500
Ugandan Science Center Manager	Annually	\$	\$1,300	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$1,300
Biomass briquetting staff	\$6/day/staff - (7, part time) \$6/day/staff - (3, part time)	\$	\$12,750	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$12,750
Science Center Staff	\$6/day/staff (8, part time) \$6/day/staff (2, full time) \$15/month/intern (20, part time)	\$	\$13,400	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$13,400
Ugandan Artists	Annually	\$	\$4,500	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$4,500
Stove builders and other Ugandan support staff	\$6/day/staff (5, part time)	\$	\$2,880	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$2,880
Ugandan Internships	\$320/month (food & Rent) \$200/month (stipend) \$1000/annual (evac insurance)	\$2,000	\$620	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$2,620
Video shows		\$	\$500	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$500
Science Centers	\$5,000/center (5)	\$6,000	\$19,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$25,000
Meetings	\$50/meeting	\$	\$600	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$600
Staff Training Workshops	One annual trip and 3 smaller workshops	\$1,000	\$3,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$4,000
Community training workshops	(10) (Fuel efficient stove, recycling and waste, biomass briquette and family planning workshops)	\$1,500	\$			\$1,500
Biomass briquette equipment	General maintenance on all equipment	\$	\$7,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$7,000
Art Installation	Materials,	\$	\$2,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$2,000

	equipment, and storage					
Nature Connect	Botanic Gardens entry, National Park entry, Permits, Workshop materials & Transport	\$2,500	\$2,500	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$5,000
Annual Conservation Competitions	5 annually	\$2,200	\$3,600	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$5,800
Uniforms		\$800	\$			\$800
Capacity building	Alternative livelihood craft purchases, promotional materials in and ex-situ, fundraising materials	\$	\$5,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$5,000
Permits	one annual park pass for 2 people	\$	\$550	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$550
Office		\$	\$4,100	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$4,100
In-Situ travel	\$600/trip rentals (3); \$250/monthly fuel; and vehicle maintenance \$500/annual maintenance & repairs,	\$2,000	\$3,300	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$5,300
International Travel	\$2,200/trip 5 trips	\$	\$11,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$11,000
Food & Lodging Expenses	\$500/ month lodging x 3 \$25/day food x 38 days	\$	\$3,000	October 2020	Grant Funds	\$3,000
		\$	\$			\$
		\$	\$			\$
		\$	\$			\$
		\$	\$			\$
		\$	\$			\$
		\$	\$			\$
	TOTAL PROJECT BUDGET (round to nearest whole dollar)	\$18,000	\$140,850			\$158,850

BUDGET JUSTIFICATION

State why each item listed in the CGF Budget Items Form costs what it does and indicate how each item relates to the proposed scope of work. Sufficient detail should be provided to address any potential reviewer concerns with respect to cost and need. If the lifespan of equipment costing over \$500 exceeds that of the grant period, detail and justify who will assume ownership of the item. **LIMIT 2,500 CHARACTERS with spaces**

We are requesting \$18,000 from AZA to assist with the Ugandan Internship Program, Science Centers, Staff Training Workshops, Community Training Workshops, the Nature Connect program, Annual Competitions, Staff Uniforms and In-situ Travel.

- Ugandan Interns come from Makerere University and are given housing and transport stipends;
- The total year cost for Science Centers includes rent and staff at five locations and new exhibits and supplies. At \$25,000 total yearly, this is a bargain: ~50 cents per visitor last year;
- Staff workshops include travel and lodging; community workshops include snacks;
- Nature Connect includes transport and entry fees for Ugandans to tour the Tooro Botanic gardens and go Chimp Trekking in Kibale;
- Annual Competitions include prizes, staff, supplies and tent rental for these large outdoor events;
- Staff Uniforms are t-shirts and coveralls
- In-Situ Travel includes maintenance and fuel for three project vehicles: a large 4 wheel drive, a motorbike and a "freight" motorbike.

Note that several grants are pending and in preparation. "October 2020" is listed as expected date for non-CGF funds above since we expect to have all other funding by that time. Some is already secured and some will have arrived before that time.

Thank you for your time and consideration of this proposal!

Literature Cited:

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Michael Stern

Professional Experience

Philadelphia Zoo, Curator of Primates and Small Mammals, October 2017 – Present

Supervise 16 keepers and oversee the husbandry and exhibitry of the zoo's primates and small mammals

Kibale Fuel Wood Project & Kibale Eco-Char Initiative, Uganda, Project Director, October 2005 – Present

Initiated a community conservation program designed to protect Kibale National Park from encroachment

Honolulu Zoo, General Curator, July 2016 – September 2017

Supervised 3 curators and oversaw the zoo's animal collection

Denver Zoo, Assistant Curator of Primates, April 2011 – June 2016

Supervised 13 keepers and oversaw the care of over 100 monkeys, apes, prosimians and other mammals

Lemur Conservation Foundation, Florida, Executive Director, February – October 2010

Directed staff and programs at this 100 acre lemur breeding facility

Apoka Safari Lodge, Kidepo National Park, Uganda, Manager, July 2008 – July 2009

Managed 36 employees and ensured guest's excellent experience in this luxury wilderness safari lodge

Heritage Park Zoological Sanctuary, Arizona, Animal Curator, May – July 2008

Managed a crew of 4 keepers and numerous volunteers and oversaw care of the collection

Woodland Park Zoo, Seattle, Primate Keeper, March 2003 – April 2006

Primary caretaker for orangutans and siamangs, also cared for macaques, tapirs and pythons

Kibale Forest Education Project, Uganda, Founder and Director, June 2001 – February 2003

Initiated a project to bring students from 5 local schools on field trips into Kibale National Park

Philadelphia Zoo, Children's Zoo Staff, 1992 - 2002 (part-time/seasonal)

Cared for exotic and domestic animals in the Children's Zoo and performed shows on and off site

Franklin Park Zoo, Boston, Animal Keeper, July–December 1997

Cared for bongo, addax, ibex, aoudad, zebra, wildebeest, duiker, camel, ostrich, cranes, and lion

New Jersey State Aquarium, Education Staff, December 1991 – June 1996 (part-time/seasonal)

Helped create an entertaining and educational visitor experience

Education

BA in Biological Anthropology, Magna Cum Laude, from Harvard University, class of 2001.

Leadership & Service

Co-Founder and Secretary, New Nature Foundation, www.newnaturefoundation.org (2008 – Present)

Advisory Board Member, IDA-Africa (2004 - 2006)

Elected Union Liaison, Teamsters Local 117 (October 2005 – April 2006)

President, Puget Sound Chapter, American Association of Zoo Keepers (2005)

Publications & Presentations

Stern, M. (2019) Dig It: Facilitating Intrinsically Reinforcing Natural Behavior for Two Species of Mole Rats at the Philadelphia Zoo. (poster) *National Conference of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums*, New Orleans, USA.

Stern, M. (2018) Aframomum Everywhere. *National Conference of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums*, Seattle, USA.

Stern, M. (2018) Aframomum Everywhere. *International Gorilla Workshop*, Knoxville, USA.

Stern, M.; Goldstone, R. (2018) Primate Conservation through Fuel Efficiency. *International Primatological Society Congress*. Nairobi, Kenya.

Goldstone, R.; Stern, M. (2017) Edutainment as Strategic Marketing for Conservation. *Conservation Optimism Summit*, London, UK.

Stern, M.; Goldstone, R. (2016) Connecting Zoos, Research, Population & Conservation in Uganda. *EAZA Conservation Forum*. Fuengirola, Spain.

Stern M (2015) Aframomum at the Denver Zoo. (poster) *National Conference of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums*, Salt Lake City, USA.

Stern, M. (2015) Sustaining In-Situ Conservation - Beyond Funding: A Case Study from Uganda. (poster) *National Conference of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums*, Salt Lake City, USA.

Stern, M. (2014) Home-grown Paradise. *Animal Keepers Forum* 41, 2&3:47-52.

Stern, M. (2014) Aframomum Update. *International Gorilla Workshop*. Atlanta, USA.

Stern, M.; Goldstone, R (2014) Partnering with Agricultural Communities and Industry to Safeguard Primate Habitat in Uganda. *2014 Congress of the International Primatological Society*. Hanoi, Vietnam.

Stern, M.; Goldstone, R (2013) The Kibale Eco-Char Initiative: Partnering with Agricultural Communities and Industry to Safeguard Wildlife Habitat in Uganda. *Zoos and Aquaria Committing to Conservation Conference*. Des Moines, USA.

Stern, M. (2012) Aframomum for Gorilla Heart Health. *International Gorilla Workshop*, Apeldoorn, Netherlands.

Stern, M.; Goldstone, R (2007) Conservation Action in Uganda. *National Conference of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums*. Philadelphia, USA.

Stern, M, Goldstone, R. (2005) Red colobus as prey: The leaping habits of five sympatric old world monkeys. *Folia Primatologica* 76:100-112.

Stern, M. (2005) Bee-hind the Scenes. @thezoo Winter 2005.

Stern, M. (2004) AAZK Funded Environmental Education in Africa. *2004 National Conference American Association of Zoo Keepers*. Dallas, Texas.

Stern, M. (2004) Tiptoe Through the Treetops. @thezoo Fall 2004.

2020 AZA CONSERVATION GRANTS FUND

Statement of Institutional Support

One copy of this statement must be **electronically signed** by the institutional CEO/Director using the checkbox below, and submitted as an attachment to the CGF Application email titled “**SIS Institution Name**” for each institution or organization that fits one or more of the following criteria:

1. **Has an employee listed as a Principal Investigator or Co-Investigator on the Application Cover Sheet.**
2. **Is listed as a collaborating institution or organization on the Application Cover Sheet.**

By signing this form, all participating institutions, whether participating as a facility or through an employee, take responsibility for: 1) completing their part of the proposed project and 2) obtaining Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC)* or Institutional Review Board (IRB)** approvals, if necessary. All accountability for conducting responsible research lies in the hands of each participating institution, not the CGF Scientific Advisory Committee.

All *Statement of Institutional Support* forms must be received as part of the CGF Application Email.

The (*Institution Name*) New Nature Foundation has reviewed the proposal titled (*Proposal Title*) Integrated Community Conservation Action in Uganda and commits itself to providing the time, resources and/or financial support as stated in the application, and for obtaining IACUC and/or IRB approvals, if necessary, should the proposal be selected for funding by AZA's Conservation Grants Fund.

Rebecca Goldstone

Name

President

Title

(Zoos and Aquariums must include the signature of the Institutional CEO/Director above and cannot substitute the signature of the COO, General Curator, Vice President, Department Director, or Principal Investigator. Universities, Colleges, and Federal or State Government entities may substitute the signature of a Governing Official.)

3/16/2020

Date

☒ **Checking this box serves as my electronic signature to this letter of support. I affirm that I am the person listed above and understand that this letter WILL NOT be accepted unless the box is checked.**

* Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC, for U.S. applicants) or the equivalent oversight committee (for non-U.S. applicants) approval is desirable for any proposal, but is required for any project in which animals are to be involved in invasive procedures and/or procedures that may result in pain, harm, distress, and/or altering of behavior (this includes any time an animal in the wild is sedated or anesthetized). This generally excludes samples obtained during regularly scheduled veterinary or husbandry procedures or emergency medical procedures. IACUC (or the international equivalent thereof) approval is required for both *in situ* and *ex situ* projects. Each institution involved in a project must submit the project proposal to its IACUC (or equivalent) for review. In order to be considered complete, proposals must include the Statement of Institutional Support from each participating institution/organization as recognition of compliance with these IACUC (or equivalent) approval guidelines.

If an institution is not registered as a research facility or similar facility and therefore does not have an IACUC (or equivalent), it needs to become affiliated with a university, zoo, or other body that has an IACUC (or equivalent) in order to obtain approval.

** Any projects supported through CGF funding that involve human subjects must be conducted under the auspices of a federally registered Institutional Review Board (IRB) and be consistent with 45 CFR Part 690: Federal Policy for the Protection of Human Subjects if the work or researchers are based in the USA. For members submitting from outside the USA for projects to be completed entirely outside the USA and its territories may use a process that meets the requirements of the prevailing legislation for protection of human subjects where the principal investigator is based or in the country where data collection will occur, whichever is more stringent. We note that all protocols must still conform to the types of protections outlined in 45 CFR Part 690 irrespective of the reviewing organization.

2020 AZA CONSERVATION GRANTS FUND

Statement of Institutional Support

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1. **Has an employee listed as a Principal Investigator or Co-Investigator on the Application Cover Sheet.**
2. **Is listed as a collaborating institution or organization on the Application Cover Sheet.**

By signing this form, all participating institutions, whether participating as a facility or through an employee, take responsibility for: 1) completing their part of the proposed project and 2) obtaining Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC)* or Institutional Review Board (IRB)** approvals, if necessary. All accountability for conducting responsible research lies in the hands of each participating institution, not the CGF Scientific Advisory Committee.

All *Statement of Institutional Support* forms must be received as part of the CGF Application Email.

The (*Institution Name*) Philadelphia Zoo has reviewed the proposal titled (*Proposal Title*) Integrated Community Conservation Action in Uganda and commits itself to providing the time, resources and/or financial support as stated in the application, and for obtaining IACUC and/or IRB approvals, if necessary, should the proposal be selected for funding by AZA's Conservation Grants Fund.

Vikram Dewan

Name

CEO

Title

(Zoos and Aquariums must include the signature of the Institutional CEO/Director above and cannot substitute the signature of the COO, General Curator, Vice President, Department Director, or Principal Investigator. Universities, Colleges, and Federal or State Government entities may substitute the signature of a Governing Official.)

3/16/2020

Date

☒ **Checking this box serves as my electronic signature to this letter of support. I affirm that I am the person listed above and understand that this letter WILL NOT be accepted unless the box is checked.**

* Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC, for U.S. applicants) or the equivalent oversight committee (for non-U.S. applicants) approval is desirable for any proposal, but is required for any project in which animals are to be involved in invasive procedures and/or procedures that may result in pain, harm, distress, and/or altering of behavior (this includes any time an animal in the wild is sedated or anesthetized). This generally excludes samples obtained during regularly scheduled veterinary or husbandry procedures or emergency medical procedures. IACUC (or the international equivalent thereof) approval is required for both *in situ* and *ex situ* projects. Each institution involved in a project must submit the project proposal to its IACUC (or equivalent) for review. In order to be considered complete, proposals must include the Statement of Institutional Support from each participating institution/organization as recognition of compliance with these IACUC (or equivalent) approval guidelines.

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